

**BUILDER
BRIGADE**
HOMEBUILDING HELP FOR HOMEOWNERS

the
ULTIMATE
HOME BUILDING
✓**checklist**

HOMEOWNER EDITION





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CONGRATULATIONS ON YOUR FUTURE NEW HOME!

How to use this Checklist:

1. Review and note your selections for each line item.
2. Remove or cross off those that don't apply.
(This is how to delete rows if you purchased the editable version: [CLICK HERE](#))
3. Provide a copy to your builder and discuss expectations and potential issues.
4. Revisit the checklist before and during each phase to ensure no items are missed.
*Some items may be duplicated because they apply to multiple categories.

Legend:

You'll find these links throughout the checklist. They'll increase and get better with each update 👍!

(A) = Articles on my site **(I)** = Images

(P) = Product (Some are affiliate links. I may receive a commission at no additional cost to you)

(V) = Video

About this Checklist:

- Organized into Phases of Construction
- All the decisions you'll face during construction and things to watch for 🤖
- No Pictures to keep it manageable
- Searchable terms used in case you're unfamiliar with some line items
- *Editable Version: The checkboxes are NOT interactive.*
To make them interactive: Developer -> Protect From
(Caveat: You will no longer be able to add/remove rows)

BORING LEGAL DISCLAIMER

Items listed on this checklist do not imply they are compliant with your local regulation and code, the items included on this list are for information purposes only and should be reviewed by a local licensed professional.

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CONTENTS

CONSTRUCTION PHASES..... 5

Land Clearing ----- 5

Foundation----- 5

Exterior Walls ----- 6

Framing ----- 7

Roofing----- 9

Siding ----- 11

Doors and windows----- 11

Attic ----- 13

Porch ----- 14

Utilitles ----- 14

Plumbing----- 16

HVAC (Air Conditioning)----- 18

Electrical Wiring----- 20

Lighting Switches ----- 22

Electrical Outlets ----- 22

Interior Lighting----- 25

Low voltage wiring----- 25

Fireplace----- 26

Insulation/Drywall ----- 27

Kitchen ----- 28

Kitchen Cabinets ----- 30

Pantry ----- 32

Bathrooms ----- 32

Laundry----- 36

Mudroom / Drop Zone ----- 37

Trim ----- 37

Paint----- 38

Stairs ----- 39

Plumbing Fixtures----- 39

Flooring ----- 39

Appliances ----- 40

Garage ----- 41

Poured Concrete (Driveway/Walkway) ----- 42

Exterior ----- 43

Miscellaneous ----- 45

YOUR LISTS47

Use This for Additional Lists ----- 47

DOOR COUNT48

WINDOW COUNT49

LIGHT FIXTURES AND FAN COUNT50

CAN I ASK A FAVOR...51

RESOURCES52



CONSTRUCTION PHASES

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
LAND CLEARING		
☐	Additional parking space: 10'x 20' minimum	
☐	Additional clearing for future structures: Building / Shed / Garden / Greenhouse / Outdoor Sauna	
☐	Additional clearing for alternate driveway	
Considerations		
☐	Clear trees that may need to be removed in the next 10 years (it's way cheaper now)	
☐	Mark trees you want to keep with flagging tape (P)	
☐	Minimum 50' clearance of trees from any structure	
☐	Extra rock on jobsite = less mud being tracked inside the house (V)	
FOUNDATION		
BASEMENT		
☐	Basement type: Walkout / Full / Partial / Storm shelter	
☐	Basement finish: Fully finished / Partially / None	
☐	Garage door/large entrance to store equipment	
☐	High ceilings	
☐	Wood stove	
☐	Basement egress window - if planning to finish as living space	
SLAB		
☐	Slab type: Monolithic / Stem-Wall (V)	
CRAWLSPACE		
☐	Encapsulation (highly recommended) (V)	
☐	Dehumidifier	
☐	Concrete crawlspace floors. Enables access inside crawlspace via mechanic's creeper. (Significant price increase) (V)	
☐	French drain inside crawlspace perimeter	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Crawlspace sump pump	
☐	Crawlspace vent material: Plastic / Metal	
☐	Crawlspace automatic vents (P)	
☐	Crawlspace vents blend with veneer wall (V)	
MISC. FOUNDATION		
☐	Reinforced area for unusually heavy objects: large gun safe	
☐	Pour footers or slab for pre-made storm shelters (P) (slab only requires +2500 psi concrete)	
☐	French drains around foundation	
Considerations		
☐	<u>Basement</u> : Waterproofing of basement exterior walls (V)	
☐	<u>Slab</u> : Expansion or control joints cut in the slab (Usually within 6-12hrs of pour) (V)	
☐	<u>Slab</u> : electrical and plumbing is permanent. Consider locations that need electrical conduit and plumbing (kitchen island, outlets in center of room, outdoor kitchens) (V)	
☐	<u>Slab</u> : Look for high points in the slab that may need to be chipped and grinded down	
☐	<u>Crawlspace</u> : If no encapsulation, plastic should still be present under the crawlspace (V)	
EXTERIOR WALLS		
☐	Exterior wall type: Cinder Block / Wood Framing / Insulated Concrete Forms (ICF) (V)	
☐	Exterior wall stud size: 2x4 / 2x6	
☐	Exterior wall stud spacing: 16" OC / 24" OC (16" on-center (OC) is standard, some prefer 24" to save money) (V)	
☐	Exterior sheathing material: Zip / Plywood / OSB	
☐	Exterior sheathing thickness: 3/8" or 1/2"	
☐	Exterior wrap: Traditional / Zip System (attached to plywood)	
EXTERIOR INSULATION		
☐	Insulated Concrete Forms (ICF)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Insulated sheathing	
☐	Foam board	
☐	Rolled batts	
☐	Flash & batt (combination of spray foam and fiberglass batt)	
☐	Spray foam (Open or closed cell)	

Considerations

☐	Zip Tape should be rolled (V)	
☐	Some homes are being built with foam for exterior sheathing. Confirm your builder is NOT using this material.	

FRAMING

☐	Interior wall stud spacing: 16" OC / 24" OC	
☐	First floor ceiling height: 8' / 9' / 10' / 12' / 14'	
☐	Second floor ceiling height: 8' / 9' / 10' / 12' / 14'	
☐	Wood bracing/blocking (no drywall anchors needed) (V) : • Curtain rods • Heavy pictures • TV mounts • Towel rods • Porch swing • Outdoor hose reel • Toilet paper holder • Speaker mounts • Stair handrail • Shower grab bars • Shower curtain • Shower glass • Thermostat • Paper towel mount • Floating shelves	
☐	Blocking behind door handle location. (Easily fix holes made from the door handle)	
☐	Advantech subfloor panels instead of OSB (reduces squeaks and can handle a rainy jobsite)	
☐	Bottom plate sealing (aka Sill Plate sealing) (V)	

CEILINGS

☐	Coffered ceiling: <u>Finish</u> - Drywall / Exposed wood (beam) / Painted wood <u>Location</u> – rooms with coffered ceiling	
☐	Tray ceiling locations (optional: with cove lighting)	
☐	Barrel ceiling locations	
☐	Doorway arch locations	
☐	Shade pockets in the ceiling or behind the trim (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
ATTIC		
☐	Extra plywood added to the attic floor for more storage	
☐	Cheap or leftover flooring on attic floor (Vinyl, laminate, etc.)	
☐	Attic access door (larger the better) (V)	
☐	Cat walks to main areas of the attic (V)	
PEST CONTROL		
☐	Right before insulation goes in, ask the builder if you can sprinkle Boric Acid on the bottom plate of framing. A pest control measure for the life of your home. (V)	
☐	Bora-Care termite treatment to bottom of wall framing (V)	
☐	In-wall pest control (A) (V)	
☐	Bottom plate sealed for air gaps/bugs (V)	
MISC. FRAMING		
☐	Garage: At least 24' depth for vehicle (V)	
☐	Recessed area behind fridge to fit standard depth fridge. This should be a 2x6 wall not 2x4 wall. (V)	
☐	Built-in package drop box (P) (V)	
☐	Staggered framing for noise dampening and increased insulation (V)	
☐	Stair tread material is dimensional lumber not plywood	
☐	Reinforced roof for solar panel weight	
☐	Shower seat: Corner / Bench	
☐	Shower niches	
☐	Wall niches / Art niches	
☐	Dumbwaiter (V)	
☐	Laundry chute (V) / Laundry Jet	
☐	Under stair access for storage use (V)	
☐	Built-in knee wall storage	
☐	Access door to possible unused storage areas (V)	
☐	Built-in storage for unused areas (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Transfer grilles above the doors (V) (A/C pass easily, no door slamming)	
☐	PT plywood on bottom 2' of exterior sheathing	
☐	Budget friendly Safe Room: 2x6 studs (8" spacing) with ¾ plywood (V)	
☐	Safe door reinforcement	
☐	Hidden room: Door location / Door type (P)	
☐	Slideaway Safe (Picture frame) (P)	
☐	Central vacuum system	
☐	Christmas Tree Closet (V)	

Considerations

☐	Screws and adhesive used on subfloor instead of nails (reduce squeaks) (V)	
☐	No excessive bowed or twisted studs (V)	
☐	Ensure large sections of missed nails (shiners) are replaced with nails that penetrate the stud. (V)	
☐	No ripped or missing exterior house wrap. Zip system seams are sealed with tape (if applicable)	
☐	Window and/or door headers are the same height. The top of windows and/or doors should make a straight line across (V)	
☐	Cover trusses and lumber with plastic. Some builder will do this already. Trusses are notorious for sitting out for months.	

N You should see the following once framing is complete (Only if applicable):
O • Ceiling heights • Shower bench seat • Framing blocking/bracing • All window & door locations • Wall
T niches • Pocket door frame • Laundry Chute • Attic flooring • Fireplace • Tray Ceilings • Coffered ceilings
E • Door arches • Barrel ceilings • Half/knee walls • Skylight locations

ROOFING

☐	Roof pitch (steep): ___/12 (V)	
☐	Roof sheathing material: Zip / Plywood / OSB	
☐	Radiant barrier OSB for roof sheathing (P) (V)	
☐	Roof sheathing thickness: 1/2", 5/8"	
☐	Material: Asphalt / Metal / Tile	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Asphalt type: 3-tab / Architectural	
☐	Roof color	
☐	Metal roof: Standing seam (not exposed fastener)	
☐	Chimney style	
☐	Faux chimney to hide roof penetrations (V)	
☐	Heavier underlayment	
☐	Ice and water shield on roof edges and valleys (Can be used in all climates)	
☐	Small roof or awning over exterior doors (V)	
☐	Skylights and/or solar tubes	
☐	Roof vent pipe boots: lead / rubber	
☐	Kick out flashing (V)	

Considerations

☐	If radiant barrier OSB is used for roof sheathing, spray foam should not be applied directly to the radiant barrier. It negates all benefits of the radiant barrier without an air gap. (V)	
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GUTTERS

☐	Gutters with gutter guards (V)	
☐	Gutter size: 5" / 6"	
☐	Gutter style: K-style / Half-round	
☐	Gutter downspout style: K-style / Round	
☐	Underground gutter drains (PVC / SDR has better durability than corrugated) (V)	
☐	Wye PVC connector at gutter drain to clear clogs if needed	

Considerations

☐	Roof underlayment is not missing or blowing in the wind	
☐	Roof shingles should overhang 1/2"-3/4" from drip edge, they should not be sagging off the edge	
☐	Drip edge is present	
☐	Toe boards are not nailed into finished roof (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	No exposed nail heads on finished roof	
SIDING		
☐	Siding material: Brick / Stucco / Vinyl / Fiber cement / Wood (V)	
☐	Siding color	
☐	Rainscreen utilized (Airspace between sheathing and siding)	
☐	Soffit material: Fiber cement / vinyl / wood / Aluminum	
☐	Soffit type: vented / non-vented	
☐	Soffit color (V)	
☐	Fascia material: Aluminum / Fiber cement / PVC / Wood	
☐	Fascia color	
☐	Veneer wall material: Brick / Stone / Other	
☐	Veneer walls: Anchored / Adhered	
☐	Veneer walls color	
☐	Exterior window and door trim style	
Considerations		
☐	Vinyl siding could possibly melt from neighbor's window reflection (V)	
☐	Material: Ensure joint flashing is being used behind butt joints on horizontal siding. *Not tar paper, house wrap or caulking	
☐	Veneer walls should be protected with plastic to avoid staining (especially in locations with clay dirt) (V)	
☐	Brick Siding: The pile of sand on the jobsite is for the exterior brick mortar mix, if the dirt on the jobsite is mixed in accidentally, it can change the color of the mortar when installed	
DOORS AND WINDOWS		
DOORS		
☐	Front door height and width	
☐	Front door style, window, and color	
☐	Front door window: sidelites / transom / both (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Interior door height and width	
☐	Pocket door locations	
☐	Soft-close pocket doors	
☐	Sliding barn door locations	
☐	Oversized hallways / door openings	
☐	Larger 36" door openings	
☐	Doggy door (wall mounted) (P)	
☐	Costco Door (Access to pantry from garage for groceries) (V)	
☐	Door stop style: floor / baseboard / hinge	
☐	Baseboard door stop raised to clear robot vacuum	
☐	Hidden Murphy Door (P)	

Considerations

☐	If concerned about security: Make sure glass is tempered, opt for transom window without sidelites (V)	
☐	Ask builder to lock the front door after installation to keep finished door safe from damage from contractor traffic	
☐	Ask for threshold protection for sliders and exterior doors (V)	
☐	Canned spray foam can be applied to gaps around the frame of interior doors to reduce noise transfer (I)	

WINDOWS

☐	Window height(s) (see Window Count)	
☐	Window color	
☐	Window grid pattern (V) (V2)	
☐	Sliding/retractable window screens	
☐	Casement window with built-in shade and retractable screen (V) (P)	
☐	Pantry window	
☐	Closet windows	
☐	Basement egress window - if planning to finish as living space one day	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Window spacing for king size bed (92"-94" inside to inside) (V)	
☐	Privacy window glass (bathrooms, closets, shower)	
☐	Reflective/privacy window film	
☐	Skylights and/or solar tubes (Bedrooms are not ideal if the sound of rain on the glass is bothersome)	
☐	Accordion windows	
☐	Casement windows (V)	
☐	Shade pockets (hidden shades)	
☐	Window from kitchen opening to outdoor porch area	
SHUTTERS		
☐	Decorative window shutters	
☐	Hurricane shutters: Roll-up / Accordion / Bahama / Colonial / Storm panels	
☐	Security shutters	
Considerations		
☐	Inspect for cracked or broken windows	
ATTIC		
☐	Attic flooring (Budget tip: cheap linoleum on top of plywood)	
☐	Lighting	
☐	Standard size attic door (V)	
☐	Pulldown attic ladder	
☐	Full-size attic staircase	
☐	Attic staircase hidden in closet	
☐	Insulated attic door (available for standard and pulldown) (P)	
☐	Attic Lift (P)	
☐	Attic fan with thermostat	
☐	Whole house fan	



PORCH

☐	Porch floor material: Concrete / Wood decking / Brick / Stone / Composite (V)	
☐	Stamped concrete design and color (V)	
☐	Porch ceiling material: Fiber Cement / Vinyl / Wood	
☐	Built-in floor mat (V)	
☐	Porch ceiling color	
☐	Porch beam size (opt for the same width as the post it sits on) (V)	
☐	Porch post material and color	
☐	Porch swing mount (V)	
☐	Screened-in porch	
☐	Aluminum Plinth blocks under porch posts (V)	
☐	Porch fans	
☐	Gas lanterns (V)	
☐	Joist tape used on wood decking (extend deck joist life) (P)	
☐	Deck drainage system to utilize area under wood deck (P) (V)	
☐	Extend porch pad for grill to be rolled out in the open (V)	
☐	Spray foam porch roof to keep it cool during the summer (V)	

Considerations

☐	Install blocking before the ceiling is finished to easily mount the porch swing later (V)	
☐	Stamped concrete should be sealed to maintain color and longevity	

UTILITIES

ELECTRICITY

☐	Power lines: Underground / Power poles	
☐	Location of power poles and lines. You may be able to sweet talk the power company into your preferred location	
☐	Supplement with Solar (Consider Smart electrical panel for detailed usage of each circuit)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Location of utility meter box mounted on the house (Ask about an out of sight location)	
☐	Request a white meter box color or have it painted to match the house. (instead of the standard grey) (I)	
WATER		
☐	Source: City water / Well water	
☐	Well pump type: Submersible / Jet Pump	
GAS		
☐	Type: Natural Gas / Propane	
☐	Propane tank location	
☐	Propane tank: buried / above ground	
Considerations		
☐	Tank: The initial fill is costly and as a homeowner you have the option to buy it or rent it	
CABLE / INTERNET		
☐	Type: Cable Modem / Fiber / Satellite / DSL	
☐	Additional service locations: Detached garage, shop, pool house	
☐	*Note: Contact local cable provider ASAP to ensure services will be completed by move-in	
WASTE		
☐	Waste type: Public Sewer/ Septic System	
☐	Septic / Sewer hook-up for RV	
☐	Septic size (~1k gallons = 4 person)	
☐	Septic tank risers (easy access for pump out every 3-5 years) (P) (V)	
☐	Irrigation ground box used to hide sewer cleanout (P)	
Considerations		
☐	Utility lines (Power, water, and cable) are not buried or in the way of any future structure location like a pool	
☐	Video the location of utility lines to include the septic system. It will be useful to avoid damaging them during any future landscaping work after the house is built. (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
PLUMBING		
☐	Plumbing type: PVC / PEX (V)	
☐	Conduit in concrete for underground lines of PEX (kitchen island) (V)	
WATER HEATER		
☐	Water heater type: Tank / Tankless / Hybrid (V)	
☐	Water heater tank size and quantity: 30 / 40 / 50 / 60/ 80gal	
☐	Multiple tanks connected: Series / Parallel Note: This depends on your application, here's an article that goes into more detail (A)	
☐	Tankless water heater fuel: Electric / Propane / Natural Gas	
☐	Water heater location: Indoor / Outdoor / Room	
☐	Hot water recirculation system (Immediate hot water at furthest fixtures)	
☐	Water manifold system – Each line has its own shut-off (Pro: Less connections / Con: Slower hot water delivery)	
Considerations		
☐	Multiple water heater tanks are connected in parallel (Not in series) (V)	
☐	Drain pan under water heater tank, drained to exterior	
GAS LINE		
☐	Appliances requiring gas line: Cooktop / Oven / Fireplace / Dryer / Furnace / Outdoor kitchen / fire pit	
☐	Gas shut off for appliances in easily accessible location (Inside cabinet)	
☐	Gas and electric installed at the stove and/or Dryer. Some appliances use both or future appliance change	
☐	Gas lanterns (V)	
☐	Gas line to Outdoor grill and/or firepit (V)	
☐	Home generator	
☐	Pool heater	
Considerations		
☐	Main gas shutoff location	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
SINKS AND DRAINS		
☐	Sinks and drains: Kitchen, bathrooms, pantry, garage, laundry, wet bar, outdoor	
☐	Bathtub drain position: Left, right, center (especially important for slab foundations)	
☐	Drain hidden in the corner of the room in case of accidental flooding. (Bathrooms, laundry, water heaters, washer, dishwasher)	
☐	Grey water pipe for washing machine (for those on septic)	
☐	Floor drains	
☐	Use cast iron pipe for second floor toilet drain so you don't hear the toilet water from downstairs (V)	
☐	Robot vacuum/mop drain line	
Considerations		
☐	Floor drains that rarely get used: Use mineral oil in p-trap or a drain seal to prevent evaporation and sewer gas smell	
HOSE BIBS		
☐	Hose bib on all sides of the house	
☐	Threaded and replaceable hose bib (not soldered or perm. fixed) (V)	
☐	Hot water hose bib (V)	
☐	Aquor hose bibs	
☐	Hose bib at unusual location: Garden / Middle of yard / Shed	
☐	In-ground Hose Bib (P)	
☐	Porch hose bibs	
☐	Outdoor shower	
WATER FILTRATION		
☐	Water softener plumbing	
☐	Water softener salt chute (I)	
☐	Water filtration system: whole home / partial	
MISC. PLUMBING		
☐	Sink locations	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Urinal plumbing	
☐	Built-in wall water fountain / bottle filler (P)	
☐	No use of CPVC pipe in the house (Cracks over time)	
☐	Specific location of water main shut-off	
☐	Automatic water main shut-off leak detector (P)	
☐	Fridge water line shutoff in easily accessible location (typically located behind fridge requiring you to pull it out)	
☐	Fridge water line is connected to filtered water connection. Water lines may need be run through cabinets	
☐	Water line for robot vacuum/mop	
☐	Individual water shut-off valves for each appliance	
☐	Water hammer arrestor shut-off valves (V) (Washer, dishwasher, fridge)	
☐	Exterior wall plumbing is heavily insulated or installed through the floor, avoiding the exterior wall altogether. (I)	
☐	Wet bar glass chiller (V) (P)	
☐	Plumbing for filtered water to fridge, sink, bottle filler	
☐	Request ball valves over gate valves for shutoff locations	
☐	Fire sprinkler system	
☐	Shower Dryer (P) (V)	
HVAC (AIR CONDITIONING)		
☐	Heat Recovery Ventilator (HRV) or Energy Recovery Ventilator (ERV) *Brings fresh air into the home (V)	
☐	Whole house fan	
☐	Exterior HVAC pipe covers (P)	
CENTRAL AIR CONDITIONING		
*Sends air to the home through ducts. Consists of unit(s) outside with air handler(s) inside attic or basement		
☐	A/C ductwork location: Crawlspace / Basement / Attic *This determines ceiling vs floor vents	
☐	Conditioned or vented location for air handler - improves efficiency/longevity of equip.	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	HVAC zoning system for controlling temperature to each zone/room.	
☐	A/C ducts – rigid metal on trunk lines (from handler), flexible ducts from trunk lines to the interior vents. Complete metal rigid lines can be louder.	
☐	Number of HVAC units: 1 or 2 (Unit for 1st floor and unit for 2nd floor)	
☐	Room thermostat sensors (instead of house temp determined at wall thermostat)	
☐	Smart thermostat	
☐	Secondary drain pan for air handler	
☐	Returns in multiple room instead of one central location	
☐	Drain pan emergency shut off switch (P) (V)	
☐	Transfer grilles above the doors (V) (A/C pass easily, no door slamming)	
☐	Vents are covered and protected from construction debris (V)	

DUCTLESS MINI SPLIT

* Does not utilize ducts. Mini Split allows temperature to be controlled by zone/room. Consists of one unit outside with indoor head unit (unsightly for some) for each zone/room. Not always ideal for larger applications or harsh/humid environments.

☐	Indoor head unit: Ceiling cassette / Floor mounted / Wall mounted	
☐	Number of head units needed (zone/rooms)	

FURNACE

☐	Fuel type: Gas / Electric / Propane / Oil	
☐	Location: Attic / Basement / Crawlspace	
☐	Furnace stage: Single stage / Two stage / Multi-stage	

Note: Geothermal Heating

Geothermal heating is also available. It consists of underground pipes that circulate fluid and transfer the ground's natural heat back into the home. This can also be used for radiant floor heating.

Considerations

☐	Ensure flexible ducts are not pinched. If duct appears pinched, squeeze the insulation to feel if inside duct is restricting airflow. (V)	
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✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	All thermostats in one location. Outside the primary bedroom is a common location. This requires a sensor, so the thermostat knows the temp. for the room(s) it controls.	
☐	Dedicated unit/control for the bedroom if you like the bedroom way colder than the rest of the house.	
☐	Consider the location of the outdoor unit. It can be noisy and not ideal near a bedroom or entertainment area.	
ELECTRICAL WIRING		
☐	12-gauge (20 amp) wiring to outlets and 14 gauge for lighting (at a minimum)	
☐	Smart electrical panel (P)	
☐	Whole home surge protector	
IN-WALL CONDUIT (SMURF TUBE) FOR ANY FUTURE WIRING		
☐	Conduit to Structured Media Enclosure from attic/crawlspace/basement (V)	
☐	Conduit from the attic to the basement	
☐	To TV from receiver location (V)	
☐	To primary media locations (Gaming/Entertainment/Audio)	
☐	Ask electrician about conduit to main electrical panel for future wiring	
☐	Access from attic to porch ceiling void	
DEDICATED ELECTRICAL CIRCUITS		
☐	Dedicated electrical circuits: (V) Fridges/Freezers • Large appliances • Outdoor heater • Bathroom heater • Garbage disposal • Car charger • Sump pump • Sauna • Structured Media Enclosure closet (if using multiple devices) • Coffee Bar	
ELECTRICAL POWER LOSS		
☐	Home Generator wiring (V)	
☐	Home battery backup	
☐	Portable generator backup - transfer switch	
☐	List items you want powered by generator (fridge/freezer/lights)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
OUTDOOR ELECTRICAL		
☐	Driveway gate: sensors / gate / gate opener / lights	
☐	Driveway column lighting (V)	
☐	Internet or electricity to shed or building	
☐	Pool and/or hot tub wiring and lighting	
☐	Pool heater	
☐	Built-in heaters on the front/back porch	
☐	Outdoor movie area conduit and wiring	
SECURITY		
☐	Security system: wired / wireless	
☐	Siren sound to play inside and outside (so neighbors can hear)	
☐	Security cameras: Wired (POE wiring) (P) (V)	
☐	Flood lights on each corner of the house (V)	
☐	Electric shutter wiring	
ELECTRICAL WIRING MISC.		
☐	Stair lighting (V)	
☐	Garbage disposal switch (P)	
☐	Home theater system	
☐	Crawlspace/Attic lighting	
☐	Intercom system	
☐	Multi-room audio (living/bathroom/porches/outdoor speakers)	
☐	Electric shades or curtains. Confirm shade type before deciding which wire type is required for each window.	
☐	Dumbwaiter for second floor	
☐	Gas and electric installed at the stove and/or Dryer. Some appliances use both or future appliance change	
☐	Ti-D wire to organize electrical wiring (P)	
☐	Built-in bunk bed light (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Wall-mounted picture light (P)	

Considerations

☐	You can ask for some extra slack in wiring outside the gang box (within the wall)	
☐	Walk through the electrical panel to understand all labels, make notes as necessary. Create detailed legend if necessary	

LIGHTING SWITCHES

☐	Switch type: Rocker / Toggle (V)	
☐	Dimmable switches	
☐	Wall switch timers	
☐	Smart switches (P)	
☐	Humidity sensor switch (P)	
☐	Bedroom light switch within reach (while in bed) (V)	
☐	Occupancy sensor switches (auto turn on when entering room) (P) (V)	
☐	Top and bottom of stairs	
☐	Fireplace on/off switch	
☐	Outdoor flood light switch in primary bedroom (V)	
☐	Exterior lights on built-in timer switches	
☐	Exterior string light switch	

Considerations

☐	If asked about a preferred switch location: Walk into the room and pretend to flick the light on, the side you naturally use should be the spot.	
☐	Switch locations are not too close to door trim or up against something where a switch plate would not fit	

ELECTRICAL OUTLETS

☐	Outlet style: Duplex / Decor	
☐	Childproof outlets	
☐	Phone charging stations Island endcap • In-wall cubby • Entryway built-in • Charging drawer	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Pop-up / Pop-out outlets	
KITCHEN		
☐	Top of cabinets outlet (decorative lighting)	
☐	Outlets inside kitchen cabinets/drawers – (chargers/small appliances) (P) (V)	
☐	Outlets under upper cabinets for countertop use	
☐	Island outlets (confirm with builder) (V)	
☐	Adjustable depth electrical outlet box for backsplash (P)	
BATHROOM		
☐	Behind the toilet outlet for bidet (V)	
☐	Wall mounted make-up mirror wiring (hardwired)	
☐	Outlets inside vanity cabinets/drawers (chargers/hair tools) (P) (V)	
☐	Backlit vanity mirror outlet (P)	
☐	Towel warmer / dryer (hardwired or outlet) (V)	
BEDROOM		
☐	Nightstand outlets with USB (some prefer higher on wall)	
☐	Outlets in closets (handheld steamer, air freshener) (V)	
☐	Middle or bedside (nightstands/adjustable beds/heating pad)	
☐	High outlet in corner of the room to be used as a baby monitor (V)	
OTHER		
☐	Night light location (hallways)	
☐	Built-in night lights (P)	
☐	Outlet in laundry for ironing or steamer (consider dedicated circuit, iron pulls lots of power)	
☐	Floor outlets (lamps, power recliner)	
☐	High outlet in cleaning closet (cordless vacuum)	
☐	Robot vacuum outlet	
☐	Higher outlet at computer desk with USB	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Structured Media Enclosure closet	
☐	In wall niche outlet (electronic photo album display)	
☐	Electric litter box location	
OUTDOOR		
☐	Outlet for pellet grill	
☐	Outdoor string light outlet with switch	
☐	Outdoor Porch/Patio ceiling for outdoor heater (hardwired or outlet)	
☐	Back porch TV outlet	
☐	Porch wall outlets	
GARAGE		
☐	Garage/porch high outlet for fan	
☐	240v outlet for RV hook-up, welder, table saw, etc.	
☐	240v outlet for electric car: inside / outside	
☐	Extra garage outlets (mounted high)	
☐	Inside garage cabinets (drill chargers)	
☐	Retractable extension cord outlet (P)	
☐	Sauna 240v outlet	
CHRISTMAS OUTLETS		
☐	Under soffit outlets for Christmas lights (V)	
☐	Wall switch timer for Christmas lights outlets (P)	
☐	Both sides of front door for decorations	
☐	Top and bottom of stairs (decorations)	
☐	Christmas tree location	
☐	Window outlets	
☐	Yard outlets for decorations	
☐	Fireplace mantel	
☐	Dormer outlet near the window	

Considerations

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Floor outlets are usually at the perfect height for a robot vacuum to hit them. Consider this if you plan on leaving something plugged into that outlet permanently	
☐	Confirm all outlets are in desired locations. Not too close to a door, window, or unsightly location. (I)	

INTERIOR LIGHTING

☐	See Light Fixtures and Fan Count	
☐	Chandelier Lift (lowers fixtures for cleaning and maint.) (P)	
☐	Light and fan combo over shower (P) (V)	
☐	Cove Lighting (hidden recessed lighting)	
☐	Shower niche lighting (V)	
☐	Stair lighting (V)	
☐	Under and top of cabinet lighting (V)	
☐	Under shelf lighting (Floating shelf)	
☐	Cabinet / Vanity toe-kick lighting	
☐	Verify all lighting fixtures are centered in key areas, including dining room, breakfast table, entryway, kitchen island, hallways, and bedrooms	
☐	Perimeter recessed lighting in main bedroom (four corners)	
☐	Light above bed for reading	
☐	Wall niche lighting	
☐	Under fireplace mantel lighting	
☐	Crawlspace and/or attic lighting	
☐	Built-in bunk bed light (V)	
☐	Wall-mounted picture light (P)	

LOW VOLTAGE WIRING

☐	CAT 6 cable (aka Ethernet) ***VERY IMPORTANT*** (V) : •Surveillance cameras (POE) •Outdoor movie area •Computers •Landline phone •Gaming devices •Printers •Wireless access points •Detached building •TVs •Doorbell	
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✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Network room (V): Dedicated closet for a Structured Media Enclosure. (AKA-Mini Network Room) Central hub for Router/CAT cable/Equip.	
☐	Ventilation for network room – only for lots of equipment (V)	
☐	Ethernet ports (CAT 6) in every room – 2 ports per room (V)	
☐	Pre-wire for electric shades. Confirm shade type before deciding which wire type is required for each window.	
☐	Hardwired smoke and carbon monoxide detectors	
☐	Backlit house numbers (V)	
SPEAKERS		
☐	Speaker locations	
☐	Speaker wire to every audio location	
☐	Wall controls for each audio zone	
LOW VOLTAGE IN-WALL CONDUIT (SMURF TUBE)		
☐	To Structured Media Enclosure or dedicated room from attic/crawlspace/basement. This should be a large diameter conduit to feed lots of low voltage cable because this will most likely be the hub for all your devices.	
☐	To TV from receiver location (Connect HDMI/CAT/etc. to the receiver)	
☐	To primary media locations (Gaming/Entertainment/Audio)	
☐	Hard to reach speaker locations	
Considerations		
☐	Low voltage wiring is typically not installed by the electrician	
☐	I prefer CAT 6 cable but CAT 5E is still adequate. Do not use shielded CAT cable unless the technician is advising it. It's costly and unnecessary for residential purposes.	
☐	Leave a pull line inside smurf tubing or conduit so you can quickly pull the wire through when the time comes (V)	
☐	If a camera doorbell is installed, ensure the wiring is installed at the best viewing angle and not obstructed.	
FIREPLACE		
☐	Fireplace locations	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Fuel: Electric / Gas / Wood	
☐	Vent Type: Direct Vent / Ventless	
☐	Surround or mantel	
☐	Mantel material and style	
☐	Fireplace hearth height: floor height / sitting height (V)	
☐	On/Off wall switch (A few complaints about remote switches)	
☐	Glass / mesh front screen	
☐	Under fireplace mantel lighting	

Considerations

☐	Ensure pilot light is quiet (ask for demo before purchase)	
☐	The fireplace hearth height may affect TV viewing angle (V)	

INSULATION/DRYWALL

☐	Insulation Material: Fiberglass / Cellulose / Wool (V)	
☐	Rooms with sound-dampening insulation (V) : Primary bedroom / Bathrooms / Laundry / Under stairs	
☐	Drywall Thickness: 1/2" or 5/8" (Standard: 1/2" walls / 5/8" ceilings) *Consider 5/8" throughout. Noise dampening, hides imperfections	
☐	Sound-dampening drywall	
☐	Wall texture: Orange Peel / Knockdown / Skip Trowel / Swirled / Flat / other	
☐	Ceiling texture: Orange Peel / Knockdown / Skip Trowel / Swirled / Flat / other (V)	
☐	Drywall corners: Bullnose (rounded) / Square (V)	
☐	Plumbing access panels (wall behind shower/tub) (V)	
☐	Insulated garage doors	
☐	Garage insulation. It's not standard and typically an upgrade	

EXTERIOR WALL INSULATION

☐	Insulated Concrete Forms (ICF)	
☐	Insulated sheathing	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Foam board	
☐	Roll / Batt	
☐	Flash & batt (combination of spray foam and fiberglass batt)	
☐	Spray foam (Open or closed cell)	
☐	Blown-in	
INTERIOR INSULATION		
☐	Spray foam (Open or closed cell)	
☐	Foam board	
☐	Roll / Batt	
☐	Flash & batt (combination of spray foam and fiberglass batt)	
☐	Blown-in	
ROOFLINE / CEILING INSULATION		
☐	Spray foam	
☐	Roll / Batt	
☐	Blown-in	
Considerations		
☐	Spray foam porch roof to keep it cool during the summer (V)	
☐	No trash left behind before insulation/drywall (V) (Under stairs, under bathtub, in the stud bays)	
☐	If radiant barrier OSB is used for roof sheathing, spray foam should not be applied directly to the radiant barrier. (V)	
KITCHEN		
☐	Appliances: Integrated / Built-in / Freestanding	
☐	Single / Double Island(s)	
☐	Island bench seating (booth style)	
☐	Range hood venting: Ducted / ductless	
COUNTERTOP		
☐	Countertop material: Granite / Quartz / Concrete / Butcher Block	
☐	Countertop thickness (Standard: 1.25")	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Thick island countertop, thinner remaining counters (V)	
☐	Countertop color	
☐	Countertop heights	
☐	Countertop edge style	
☐	Countertop protection (V)	
☐	Save sink cutout (countertop) for a cutting board or removable cover on the sink. (This can dull knife if used for cutting board)	

BACKSPLASH

☐	Backsplash style and color	
☐	Backsplash coverage and height (to ceiling?) (V)	
☐	Backsplash grout type: Cement Grout / Epoxy Grout / Single Component Grout	
☐	Use caulking (grout color) at backsplash and countertop seam. This is the first area to crack if you use grout	

Considerations

☐	Ask for caulking instead of grout at counter and backsplash joint. Has less chance of cracking, caulk can match grout color	
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SINK

☐	Sink / Workstation brand (P)	
☐	Faucet style and color	
☐	Wall mounted faucet	
☐	Single Basin sink / Double sink	
☐	Sink mount: Drop-in / Under-mount / Farmhouse / Integrated	
☐	Sink size: 30"-36"	
☐	Sink drain location: Side / Middle	
☐	Removable sink drain strainer (P)	
☐	Sink bottom wire rack	
☐	Sink pedal (P)	
☐	Sink garbage disposal: Wall switch / Air switch	
☐	Sink soap pump	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Soap dispenser tube kit (P)	
☐	Filtered water (P) (countertop (P)) (Faucet (P))	
☐	Instant hot water dispenser	
☐	Sink with built in cutting board and colander	
☐	Sink drying rack	
☐	Sink glass rinser (P)	

OTHER

☐	Pot filler (Can also be used for coffee machine and pet water bowl) (P) (V) (I)	
☐	Deck mounted pot filler (P)	
☐	Appliance drain pans (optional: in-floor drain) (P)	
☐	Water line for coffee maker/Ice maker (Similar to fridge water line)	
☐	Built-in wall water fountain / bottle filler (P)	
☐	Fridge water line is connected to filtered water connection. Water lines may need be run through cabinets	
☐	Coffee / Wet bar sink	
☐	Built-in coffee/cappuccino machine	
☐	Toe kick vacuum (under cabinet) (P)	

KITCHEN CABINETS

CABINETS

☐	Cabinet style and color	
☐	Cabinet material: Hardwood / Plywood / MDF / Particleboard	
☐	Cabinet hardware style and color	
☐	Cabinets to the ceiling (V)	
☐	Cabinet doors: Solid / Glass	
☐	Panel ready appliances (match cabinets)	
☐	Recessed area behind fridge to fit standard depth fridge. Deeper cabinets are also an option (V)	
☐	Deep drawers for all lower cabinets / Shelving for upper cabinets	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Deep drawer under wall ovens for pan storage	
☐	Pan storage with built in lid drawer (V)	
☐	Under sink drawers (wrap around plumbing) (V)	
☐	Island bookshelf end	
☐	Toe kick drawers	
☐	Toe kick lighting	
☐	Bi-fold doors (I)	
☐	Appliance Garage (I)	
ORGANIZATION		
☐	Pull out trash/recycle bin (P)	
☐	Trash bag holder behind trash can	
☐	Cutting board slide out (installed over trash)	
☐	Open shelving with underside hooks (mugs)	
☐	Range hood storage	
☐	False front drawer tray (sink storage) (P)	
☐	Vertical cookie sheet/cutting board cabinet	
☐	Peg drawer for Tupperware	
☐	Pull-out/slide-out shelves (P)	
☐	Spice rack drawer (P)	
☐	Built-in knife drawer (P)	
☐	Pull out utensil bin (P)	
☐	Angled utensil drawer (P)	
☐	Pull out paper towel dispenser	
☐	Built-in drawer dividers	
☐	Pull out pantry drawers	
☐	Family command center/drop zone (family calendar location)	
☐	Mixer lift (P) (V)	
☐	Blind corner storage shelf (P)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Hand towel rack/dryer	
PANTRY		
☐	Butler Pantry	
☐	Pantry cabinets (See Cabinets)	
☐	Pantry countertop (See Countertop)	
☐	Shelving: Wood / Wire	
☐	Mini sink	
☐	Frosted glass door	
☐	Vinyl stencil on glass door	
☐	Costco Door (Access to pantry from garage for groceries) (M)	
BATHROOMS		
☐	Exhaust fan locations	
☐	Exhaust fan size (1 CFM per sq ft)	
☐	Humidity sensor switch (P)	
TILE		
☐	Fixture brand, color, and style	
☐	Tile size, color, and style	
☐	Tile grout color	
☐	Tile grout type: Cement Grout / Epoxy Grout / Single Component Grout	
☐	Tile entire accent wall	
Considerations		
☐	No holes or missing grout	
☐	Shower sills and niche sills are sloped so it doesn't hold water	
☐	Larger tiles are easier to clean (less grout)	
VANITY		
☐	Vanity height (standard: 30"-32", comfort: 36")	
☐	Make-up vanity (height: 26"-29")	
☐	Vanity style and color	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Vanity countertop material: Granite / Quartz / Marble	
☐	Vanity countertop style, color	
☐	Countertop thickness (Standard: 1.25")	
☐	Countertop heights	
☐	Countertop edge style	
☐	Floating Vanity	
☐	Built-in vanity step (drawer – for kids)	
☐	Under sink drawers (wrap around plumbing) (V)	
☐	Toe kick lighting	
SINK		
☐	Sink mount: Drop-in / Undermount / Apron Front / Wall Mount / Integrated	
☐	Sink Style: Pedestal / Console / Vessel / Trough	
☐	Sink drain stopper: Push / Pull / Hidden / Side mount (V)	
☐	Sink faucet color and style	
☐	Wall mounted sink faucet	
☐	Sink faucet with pull out spray (with drinking fountain) (P)	
☐	Bathroom sink pop-up drains (P)	
MIRRORS		
☐	Mirror style	
☐	Backlit vanity mirror (P)	
☐	Wall mounted make-up mirror (hardwired)	
☐	Medicine Cabinet: Surface mount / Recessed	
TOILETS		
☐	Comfort height toilet (height: 17"-19")	
☐	Wall hung toilet	
☐	Bidet toilet (Needs hot water and/or outlet)	
☐	Skirted toilet design (one and two-piece designs available)	
☐	Soft close toilet seats	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
Considerations		
☐	No offset toilet flange unless absolutely necessary (V)	
☐	Hot water or outlet to toilet for bidet (Some types only require an outlet)	
☐	The toilet drain is centered in the space, not too close to shower or vanity	
TUB(S)		
☐	Tub Type: Freestanding / Drop-in / Corner / Alcove	
☐	Tub Material: Fiberglass / Acrylic / Cast iron / Porcelain / Vikrell / Ceramic	
☐	Tub faucet color and style	
☐	Location of tub faucet: Left / Right / Centered / Wall mount	
☐	Ceiling mounted tub filler (V)	
☐	Double person tub (Opt for side by side, optimal during single use)	
☐	Bathtub drain position: Left, right, center	
☐	Fiberglass tub: one piece / two piece (opt for one piece for easier cleaning, no seam for mold)	
☐	Tub sitting on bed of mortar (prevents floor flex) (V)	
☐	Ceiling / Wall mounted tub filler (P)	
☐	Spray foam around tub for insulation	
Considerations		
☐	Tub faucet pipe is fixed to a stud/backer (can't pull away from tub) (V)	
☐	Free standing bathroom tub plumbing (Faucet plumbing from floor, requires early planning with slab foundations)	
☐	Ask builder to protect tub during construction. (Foam board with a piece of plywood on the top and sides) (V)	
SHOWER(S)		
☐	All glass shower / Partial glass shower	
☐	Shower Guard glass treatment (Keeps glass looking cleaner from soap scum and hard water stains)	
☐	Shower faucet color and style	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Tile size and color	
☐	Two shower heads	
☐	Wall mounted body sprays	
☐	Handheld shower wand (Consider mounting lower to reach kids, shaving, and pets)	
☐	Shower valve handle location (not directly under shower head to avoid being sprayed when turning on the shower) (V)	
☐	Shower Niche (shampoo shelf): Size and Count	
☐	Shower niche lighting	
☐	Shower niche tile (typically different than shower tile)	
☐	Shower seat: Corner / Bench	
☐	Lower wall niche for shaving	
☐	Towel holder locations	
☐	Shower handle access through shower glass (V)	
☐	Shower glass towel access (V)	
☐	Specific shower head height (72" is standard / 80" is ideal)	
☐	Shower grab bars	
☐	Light and fan combo over shower (P)	
☐	Curbless shower	
☐	Linear shower drain – Drain cover style (match tile / metal)	
☐	Built-in drain hair catch (P)	
☐	Music in shower	
☐	Digital water thermostat	
☐	Shower Dryer (P) (V)	
MISC. BATHROOM		
☐	Wet room bathroom	
☐	Towel warmer/dryer (P)	
☐	Radiant floor heating	
☐	Wall/ceiling mounted heater	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Linen closet shelves: Wood / Wire	
☐	Pocket door	
☐	Outdoor bathroom for outdoor space/kids/pool	
☐	Toilet paper holder style: Standard / Niche (P)	
☐	Built-in sauna	
☐	Sink Genie – Kid's sink see through P-trap (P)	
☐	Hot water recirculation system (Immediate hot water at furthest fixtures)	

Considerations

☐	If splitting an exhaust fan between toilet and shower, consider closer to the shower to prioritize evacuating moisture	
☐	Tile in the shower that might accumulate water should have a slight tilt, so water falls away. (Niche, glass sill, bench)	
☐	Use caulking (grout color) where wall tile meets the floor tile. This is the first area to crack if you use grout	

LAUNDRY

☐	Cabinet style and color	
☐	Countertop material: Granite / Quartz / Marble	
☐	Countertop style, color	
☐	Built-in features: Ironing board • Folding table (slide-out) • Drying rack • Hanger rod • Laundry basket storage (slide-out)	
☐	Built-in washer and dryer (under counter)	
☐	Built-in litter box inside cabinet (optional kitty fart fan) (V)	
☐	Open or cabinet storage for a rolling laundry basket (V)	
☐	Steam Closet (P) (V)	
☐	Drying rack: Wall mount (P) / Ceiling mounted (P) / In-Drawer (P)	
☐	Exposed shelving: Wire / Wood	
☐	Sink with threaded faucet (P)	
☐	Wall mounted faucet	
☐	Sink mount: Freestanding / Undermount / Drop-in	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Double basin sink	
☐	Jentle Jet laundry sink (P)	
☐	Recessed dryer vent box (P) (If able, vent to the side of house...not roof)	
☐	Dryer vent being discharged horizontally instead of vertically. *Requires nearby exterior wall (V)	
☐	Dryer vent being discharged on the side of the house instead of the roof. If roof, ensure no bug screen, it will clog	
☐	Dog washing station (V)	
☐	Appliance drain pan with in-floor drain (P)	
☐	Robot vacuum cubby (V)	
☐	Robot vacuum/mop with dedicated drain and water refill line	
☐	Laundry Chute / Laundry Jet	
☐	Grey water pipe for washing machine drain	
☐	Drain hidden in the corner of the room in case of accidental flooding. Use mineral oil in p-trap or a drain seal to prevent evaporation and sewer gas smell	
☐	Water leak sensors (P)	

MUDROOM / DROP ZONE

☐	Built-ins with wall hooks	
☐	Shoe storage (Drawers keep them out of sight)	
☐	In-cabinet/In-drawer outlets	
☐	Seating with drawers/storage	
☐	Cubbies	

TRIM

☐	Interior trim style and size (around doors and windows)	
☐	Crown molding style	
☐	Crown and picture rail molding (V)	
☐	Baseboard trim style and size	
☐	Shoe molding style	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	No baseboard style: No Base / Flush Base / Reveal Base	
☐	Built-in pantry shelves	
☐	Built-ins around TV or fireplace	
☐	Built-in mudroom bench/cubby/lockers	
☐	Shiplap / Board & Batten walls	
CLOSETS		
☐	Built-in closet shelves	
☐	Closet island	
☐	Open or cabinet storage for a rolling laundry basket (V)	
☐	Rotating shoe storage (P)	
CUSTOM BUILT-INS		
☐	Bunk Beds	
☐	Office Desk	
Considerations		
☐	Use a trim rack to keep the trim organized and off the floor (V)	
PAINT		
☐	Exterior color	
☐	Exterior trim color	
☐	Fascia color	
☐	Soffit color	
☐	Interior wall color	
☐	Interior trim/baseboard color	
☐	Accent wall colors	
☐	Stair riser color	
☐	Stair tread color	
☐	Accent wall color(s)	
Considerations		
☐	Satin sheen for the exterior is easier to clean and maintain (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Match exterior caulking with paint color (V)	
☐	Paint interior of dormer window flat black (2 coats) to hide raw lumber color.	

STAIRS

☐	Stair finish: Carpet / Hardwood	
☐	Stair tread stain color	
☐	Handrail type and design	
☐	Handrail color	
☐	Stair lighting types (V) : Wall mounted recessed • Under each step • Illuminated rails • Low profile mounted on step	
☐	Stair protection during the build (V)	

Considerations

☐	Stair tread material is dimensional lumber not plywood	
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PLUMBING FIXTURES

☐	Kitchen sink style and features	
☐	Pot filler (16-22" above stove, measure your tallest pot)	
☐	Main bathtub/shower	
☐	Main bath sinks	
☐	Alternate bathroom tub/shower	
☐	Alternate bathroom sinks	
☐	Toilet style	
☐	Garage sink	
☐	Laundry sink	
☐	Pantry sink	
☐	Wet bar sink	

FLOORING

☐	Materials: Tile / Luxury Vinyl / Standard Vinyl / Hardwood / Carpet / Stone / Laminate / Concrete	
☐	Primary flooring material, color, and location	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Primary bathroom flooring material and color	
☐	Secondary flooring material, color, and location	
☐	Bathroom flooring material and color	
☐	Tile grout type: Cement Grout / Epoxy Grout / Single Component Grout	
☐	Tile grout color and line size	
☐	Concrete flooring color	
☐	Radiant floor heating	

Considerations

☐	LVP: Confirm with builder the exact type, sometimes glue down is used instead of floating	
☐	The flooring should be installed with a random look. A pattern should not be noticeable, the H-joint and waterfall/staircasing pattern is not ideal (unless you prefer it for some reason)	
☐	Split the door, not the jam. Change in flooring is under the door so you don't see the transition from the other side.	

APPLIANCES

☐	Appliances: Integrated / Built-in / Freestanding	
☐	Panel ready appliances (match cabinets)	
☐	Fridge	
☐	Spare fridge	
☐	Standup freezer	
☐	Drink fridge	
☐	Range hood with remote blowers (quieter)	
☐	Range hood venting: ducted / ductless	
☐	Cooktop: Gas / Electric / Induction	
☐	Cooktop size: 30" / 36"	
☐	Double oven	
☐	Over-the-Range Microwave / Microwave drawer	
☐	Range oven	
☐	Gas / Electric / Induction Cooktop	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Ice maker	
☐	Dishwasher	
☐	Washer and Dryer	
☐	Dishwasher Sink Combo (P) (V)	
☐	Steam Closet (P) (V)	
☐	Wine Cooler	
☐	Water bottle filler (P)	

Considerations

☐	Add felt pad to the bottom of appliances that can cause scratches during installation	
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GARAGE

☐	At least 24' depth for vehicle	
☐	Garage door height of 7' (fits most large trucks). Measure your vehicle to be sure.	
☐	Epoxy floor (28 days after concrete finished)	
☐	Built-in floor mat (V)	
☐	Sink (hot & cold) with threaded faucet (P)	
☐	Wi-Fi garage door opener	
☐	Wall mounted garage door opener (P)	
☐	Front and back garage doors (one leads to driveway, other to backyard)	
☐	Ceiling fan or wall mounted fan (high outlet) (P)	
☐	In-ceiling speakers	
☐	Wireless access point	
☐	Garage insulation (Not always standard depending on location)	
☐	Garage door insulation	
☐	Garage door style	
☐	Garage door windows	
☐	Double garage doors (pull in/out) (V)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Garage side door (man door)	
☐	Electric car 240v outlet / Welder / Table saw (V)	
☐	Wi-Fi sprinkler control	
☐	High outlets	
☐	Extra lighting/outlets	
☐	Retractable extension cord / Air compressor hose reel (P)	
☐	Floor outlets for shop tools (table saw)	
☐	Garage floor drain	
☐	Drain at garage door threshold (if rainwater flows toward garage)	
☐	Ice maker / water fountain / bottle filler (P)	
☐	Urinal in mancave / garage	
☐	Washing machine water outlet box hot & cold for in-garage pressure washer (P)	
☐	Separate room (lawn equipment, woodworking, mancave) (V)	
☐	Trash can closet (V)	

Considerations

☐	Polyaspartic floor coatings are replacing the old epoxy coatings due to faster curing times, greater durability, and UV resistance. Same epoxy look just improved material.	
☐	Two top coats on the garage floor coating will allow for smooth mopping without snagging the flakes.	

POURED CONCRETE (DRIVEWAY/WALKWAY)

DRIVEWAY

☐	Driveway type: Gravel / Concrete / Asphalt / Stone	
☐	Driveway width: Single car ~12'-14', although 10' is standard	
☐	Driveway turn around size: 34' diameter/17' radius is ideal	
☐	Driveway gate: pillars / lights / surveillance cameras	
☐	Driveway curb for drainage (V)	
☐	Heated driveway	
☐	Culvert pipe cover: Retaining wall / Rocks / Landscaping	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Driveway Alarm (V) (P)	
CONCRETE PADS / WALKWAYS		
☐	Additional concrete pads for: Air conditioners / propane tanks / basketball hoop / vehicle parking / trash cans	
☐	Concrete for future shed (location you'll lose access to after building)	
☐	Concrete walkways designed using the most direct path (prevents cutting across grassy areas)	
☐	Concrete walkway around the entire house (V)	
☐	Stained concrete	
☐	Concrete stamping	
☐	Conduit under concrete for any future electric wiring (V)	
☐	Concrete drains: Porches / Garage floor / Garage entry	
☐	In-concrete lighting	
☐	Boat Storage parking (guidelines, sprinklers, and drain) (V)	
Considerations		
☐	Gravel driveway has a crown, so water drains to both sides (V)	
☐	Expansion or control joints cut in the slab or walkway (Usually within 6-12hrs of pour) (V)	
☐	Concrete driveway has cones to prevent contractor/visitor parking. Concrete fully cures in 28 days (weather permitting)	
☐	Concrete should not be poured on grass, plastic should be placed on the ground prior to pour	
☐	Seal concrete (after curing for one month) *Don't seal any concrete you plan to epoxy later	
EXTERIOR		
LANDSCAPING		
☐	Material: Rock / Mulch / Pine Straw / Bark	
☐	Landscape fabric (consider commercial grade)	
☐	Landscape lighting (See Exterior Lighting)	
☐	Landscape border type: Cement / Brick / Other	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Sprinklers – identify all areas that need coverage	
☐	Grass type – consider amount of daily sun on the yard. Sun/shade tolerance will drastically impact growth	
☐	Drip irrigation to plants	
☐	Drip irrigation to plant pots on the porch with a built-in drain line	
☐	Wi-Fi Sprinkler controller	
☐	Conduit under concrete for any future electric wiring (V)	
☐	Water feature	
☐	Fencing location and type	
☐	Fence gates on opposing sides of yard	
☐	French drains at all low-lying areas	
☐	Underground gutter drains (PVC / SDR has better durability than corrugated) (V)	
☐	Exterior HVAC pipe covers (P)	

Considerations

☐	Ensure adequate drainage after final grade and before sod. Notify builder of any areas collecting water	
☐	Ensure all trash is removed before final grade, unfortunately sometimes this makes it into the final grade	

EXTERIOR LIGHTING

☐	Under Soffit Lighting	
☐	Exterior wall lighting (up/downlighting)	
☐	Front porch gas lanterns (V)	
☐	Landscape lighting (spotlights, up/downlighting, garden, bollard)	
☐	Smart landscape lighting transformer	
☐	Tree lighting	
☐	Step lighting	
☐	Flood lights	
☐	String lights	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	In-concrete lighting	
OUTDOOR ENTERTAINING		
☐	Outdoor fireplace / Pit (V)	
☐	Outdoor heaters and fans	
☐	Outdoor kitchen	
☐	Retractable sun / bug screens	
☐	Built-in grill	
Considerations		
☐	Video record landscape and yard sprinklers line locations during installation	
MISCELLANEOUS		
WI-FI ENABLED UPGRADES		
☐	Oven	
☐	Deadbolt	
☐	Doorbell	
☐	Thermostat	
☐	Electrical Panel (P)	
☐	Individual room HVAC sensors	
☐	Sprinkler Control	
☐	Garage door opener	
☐	Landscape light transformer	
☐	Water main monitor automatic shut-off (P)	
PETS		
☐	Pet bath station sink	
☐	Pet water faucet / pot filler	
☐	Pet bowl wall niche with drain (V)	
☐	HIDEAGATE Retractable dog gate (P)	
☐	Exterior automatic water bowl (P)	
☐	Automatic dog door (P)	

✓	Checklist Items	Notes / Links / Final Selection & location
☐	Built-in litter box inside cabinet (optional kitty fart fan) (V)	
DESIGN		
☐	Coffee bar in primary bathroom or pantry	
☐	Safe room for severe weather (P)	
☐	Central vacuum system	
☐	Washer and dryer in the primary closet	
☐	Alternate interior wall textures (brick, stucco, shiplap, etc.)	
☐	Wine Storage	
☐	Hidden Room (P)	
☐	Utility room with recessed floor (emergency drainage)	
☐	Murphy Bed (P)	

YOUR LISTS

✓ Checklist Items

Notes / Links / Final
Selections

USE THIS FOR ADDITIONAL LISTS

[illegible]

DOOR COUNT

	Location	Doors	Pocket	Sliders	Other	Notes
☐	Exterior					
☐	Entryway					
☐	Living Room					
☐	Kitchen					
☐	Pantry					
☐	Butler's Pantry					
☐	Dining					
☐	Powder Room					
☐	Breakfast					
☐	Primary Bedroom					
☐	Primary Bath					
☐	Bedroom 2					
☐	Bathroom 2					
☐	Bedroom 3					
☐	Bathroom 3					
☐	Bedroom 4					
☐	Bathroom 4					
☐	Closets					
☐	Garage					
☐	Laundry					
☐	Hallway(s)					
☐	Study / Office					
☐	Media Room					
☐	Game Room					
☐	Storage Closet(s)					
☐						
TOTALS						

WINDOW COUNT

	Location	Size 1	Size 2	Size 3	Other	Notes
☐	Entryway					
☐	Living Room					
☐	Kitchen					
☐	Pantry					
☐	Dining					
☐	½ Bath / Powder					
☐	Breakfast					
☐	Primary Bedroom					
☐	Primary Bath					
☐	Bedroom 2					
☐	Bathroom 2					
☐	Bedroom 3					
☐	Bathroom 3					
☐	Bedroom 4					
☐	Bathroom 4					
☐	Closets					
☐	Garage					
☐	Laundry					
☐	Hallway(s)					
☐	Study / Office					
☐	Media Room					
☐	Game Room					
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
TOTALS						

LIGHT FIXTURES AND FAN COUNT

	Location	Can Light	Canless	Fixtures	Fans	Notes
☐	Exterior					
☐	Entryway					
☐	Living Room					
☐	Kitchen					
☐	Pantry					
☐	Dining					
☐	½ Bath / Powder					
☐	Breakfast					
☐	Owner Bedroom					
☐	Primary Bath					
☐	Bedroom 2					
☐	Bathroom 2					
☐	Bedroom 3					
☐	Bathroom 3					
☐	Bedroom 4					
☐	Bathroom 4					
☐	Closets					
☐	Garage					
☐	Laundry					
☐	Hallway(s)					
☐	Study / Office					
☐	Media Room					
☐	Game Room					
☐						
☐						
☐						
TOTALS						

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